

Kade Smiley

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Education

University of Washington — Seattle, WA

B.S. Biology: Ecology, Evolution, and Conservation (in progress)

B.S. Environmental Science and Resource Management (in progress)

Research/Academic Experience

Undergraduate Researcher, Behavioral Ecophysics Lab

University of Washington (2025–present)

Advisors: Dr. Valentina Alaasam, Dr. Alejandro Rico-Guevara

- Project: *Effects of Urbanization on Hummingbird Coloration Through Diet*
- Conducting field capture, morphometric measurement, and feather sampling of Anna's Hummingbirds to evaluate how urbanization influences diet composition and feather coloration
- Applying stable isotope analysis to estimate trophic level and protein intake along an urbanization gradient

Senior Intern, Coastal Observation and Seabird Survey Team (COASST)

University of Washington (2024–2025)

- Oversaw incoming survey data and photographic submissions.
- Conducted data entry and verification on beached birds, marine debris, and social science surveys.
- Trained incoming interns, and managed communication with volunteers
- Worked on data management and cleaning project for future publications

Field and Laboratory Experience

- Conducted 2 field necropsies in coursework with NPS, based on GPS clusters
- Trapped and banded Common Ravens (*Corvus corax*) with rocket-netting techniques alongside Dr. John Marzluff
- Certified in Ageing Birds by Molt Limit

Technical Skills

Statistical & Programming:

- R (advanced: GLMMs, PCAs, model selection, visualization)
- Python (intermediate)

GIS & Spatial Analysis:

- ArcGIS Pro and QGIS (advanced: raster/vector workflows, spatial statistics)

Data & Productivity:

- Microsoft Excel (proficient)

Field Technology & Instrumentation

- Embedded systems: Arduino (C/C++), Raspberry Pi (Python)
- Sensor integration: temperature, humidity, light, GPS, accelerometry

- Breadboarding, circuit assembly, data logging
- Autonomous Recording Units (ARUs): deployment planning, scheduling, and audio file management for species detection and analysis

Backcountry Experience:

- Overnight trips from 1-5 nights
- Mountaineering

Additional Experience:

Camp Manager, Pedalheads: April – August, 2024

- Managed and trained 10+ staff members; ensured safety, scheduling, and communication
- Coordinated daily logistics and resolved challenges efficiently to ensure smooth operations and participant safety.

Certifications

- Certificate in Ageing Birds by Molt Limit from Powder-mill Avian Research Center

References

- Dr. John Marzluff: corvid@uw.edu
- Dr. Clint Robins: clint.robins4@gmail.com
- Dr. Alejandro Rico-Guevara: colibri@uw.edu
- Dr. Valentina Alaasam: valentina.alaasam@gmail.com